

The Consultation

Discovering a client's scent story, and the patch test that prevents a preventable reaction

Learning Objectives

- Conduct a full fragrance and ubtan consultation using guided scent-family discovery
- Administer a correct patch test protocol before any new fragrance or ubtan product
- Recognise and respond to a fragrance reaction discovered mid-consultation
- Explain why "what does she normally wear" is a better opening question than "what's your favourite scent"

Discovering a scent story, not guessing one

Most clients cannot name their preferred olfactory family unprompted, even if they can recognise it instantly on smelling it. Open with concrete, comparative questions — "do you gravitate toward warmer or fresher scents day to day," "does your everyday perfume lean floral or something else" — rather than the open-ended "what's your favourite scent," which frequently produces an unhelpfully vague answer.

The patch test, without exception

Every new fragrance and ubtan formulation must be patch tested on the inner forearm at least twenty-four hours before full application, exactly as Course VI's mehndi module required for skin-contact products. Watch for redness, itching, or swelling at the test site, and never proceed to full application if any reaction appears, regardless of how much a client insists it "isn't a big deal."

A Note from Practice

During a consultation, a client mentions offhand that a particular fragrance "always makes my skin a little itchy, but I love how it smells so I just deal with it." This is a disclosed reaction, not a preference to accommodate as stated.

The correct response is not to proceed with that fragrance because the client is willing to tolerate discomfort. It is to explain gently that a reaction, however mild she considers it, is worth taking seriously, and to guide her toward a similar scent profile in the same olfactory family without the known irritant — protecting a client from her own casual dismissal of a real signal is part of the job.

Key Terms

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Practical Activity · The Discovery Consultation

Conduct a full scent-discovery consultation with a partner using only comparative questions, and identify which olfactory family they gravitate toward by the end. Practice the patch test script aloud.